

ÆTHERIUM CODEX — NOVICE MAGIC ITEMS

Alpha Compendium | EML 1–4 | Problem/Solution Format

DESIGN NOTE

Items use the planar combination framework from the Warframe/Artifice documents. Each item has a base material phase (Solid/Liquid/Gas/Plasma), a planar source, and an EML that determines required Mastery to use reliably. Items above a wielder's Mastery still function but produce detrimental side effects (targeting paradox, physical strain, behavioral lockout per the over-mastery rules).

All items occupy the relevant inventory slot(s) noted.

CONSUMABLES

****Chirurgion's Flask**** *(Verdant Font — Flora isotope, Liquid phase)*

****EML:**** 1 | ****Slot:**** Held (consumed) | ****Value:**** Common

****The Problem:**** Your party's dedicated healer is down. Someone needs to stabilize a bleeding-out ally and nobody has Medicine ranks.

****What it does:**** A prepared alchemical compound of Font-infused botanical extract. Drinking it or applying it to a wound as a standard action restores Physical HP equal to 1d6 + the user's Vigor modifier and removes the Bleeding condition. No skill check required. The effect is immediate.

****Use Case:**** The adventure starter kit. Cheapest restoration consumable available. Works on any living creature. Available at any apothecary, chirurgion's guild office, or Mortis Aevum licensed vendor. Standard issue for Generalist College field assignments.

****Limitation:**** Does not affect condition track position — it restores HP but does not move a character up the Physical track. For that, a trained chirurgion is still required.

****Clarity Draught**** *(Synod of Endings — Archival isotope, Liquid phase)*

****EML:**** 1 | ****Slot:**** Held (consumed) | ****Value:**** Uncommon

****The Problem:**** Your character has been moved down their Mental condition track — they're Shaken or Frightened — and they need to function. You're in the middle of a situation and there's no time for therapy.

****What it does:**** Drinking this as a swift action moves the character one step up their Mental condition track. The Synod's preservation principle applied to mental state — it does not fix the underlying cause, it preserves the functional version of the mind for the duration of the encounter.

****Use Case:**** Combat stabilizer for Social and Mental attacks. A Unity Academy enforcer hits you with Emotional Broadcast and puts your whole party at Shaken — this is what you drink before your next turn. Also standard equipment for anyone operating in bleed zones where ambient Metaphysical pressure bleeds into the Mental track.

****Limitation:**** One use. Does not work on Metaphysical track damage. Unity Academy practitioners recognize the taste and know what you're compensating for.

****Planar Strain Tablet**** *(Borderlands — Earth isotope, Solid phase)*

****EML:**** 2 | ****Slot:**** Held (consumed) | ****Value:**** Uncommon

****The Problem:**** Your party is operating in a Planar Bleed zone. Strain accumulates at 1 point per hour. You have three hours of work left and your Integrity isn't high enough to absorb it safely.

****What it does:**** Ingesting this compressed mineral tablet as a standard action reduces your current Planar Strain by 2 points. It does not prevent future accumulation — it clears existing buildup. Effects last 10 minutes, after which normal accumulation resumes.

****Use Case:**** The budget solution for bleed zone operations. Professional salvage crews, Sovereign Exchange field agents, and Wildpath-adjacent prospectors carry these in bulk. They are legal, widely available, and cheap enough to dose the whole party. The Generalist College distributes them as part of standard field assignment kits.

****Limitation:**** Does not prevent accumulation — it clears it. Running them in rotation during extended zone operations is the professional approach. Maximum three doses per 24-hour period before the body stops absorbing the compounds and they become inert.

****Pale Fire Grenade**** *(Borderlands — Fire isotope + Synod of Endings — Void isotope, Plasma phase)*

****EML:** 3 | ****Slot:**** Held (consumed, thrown) | ****Value:**** Uncommon**

****The Problem:**** You need area denial — not to kill, but to force enemies out of a position or create cover for movement. You also cannot afford to reveal magical capabilities.

****What it does:**** A glass sphere filled with a Borderlands/Synod emulsion. On impact, it detonates in a small burst (Close radius). All creatures in the burst take 2d6 Æther damage (Physical). More usefully: the blast creates a wall of pale, cold fire that persists for 3 rounds. The fire deals no ongoing damage but provides total visual concealment and forces creatures to spend a standard action to pass through it. It produces no heat and almost no light — the Synod's void isotope suppresses both thermal and luminescent output.

****Use Case:**** Extraction tool. Drop it at a doorway, use the concealment to move. Works indoors and out. The pale fire is visually striking but does not illuminate — if anything, it makes the immediate area darker. Popular with Chiaroscuro-adjacent operators and Exchange enforcer teams.

****Limitation:**** The concealment works both ways. You cannot see through it any better than enemies can. Plan your exit before you throw it.

WANDS (WAND-GRADE, PERSISTENT)

****Runic Lantern**** *(Hidden Forge — Crystal isotope, Solid phase)*

****EML:** 1 | ****Slot:**** Held or Neck | ****Value:**** Common**

****The Problem:**** You are operating in a Planar Bleed zone where ambient magic has suppressed mundane light sources, or in an environment where producing visible light would compromise stealth.

****What it does:**** A palm-sized crystal etched with Deepguard-standard illumination sigils. Activating it as a free action produces bright light in a 20-foot radius and dim light for an additional 20 feet. A secondary setting (toggle as a swift action) produces light visible only to the holder via a personal sensory filter — effectively invisible to anyone else. The crystal holds 8 hours of charge and recharges in sunlight or near any significant magical heat source.

****Use Case:**** The adventurer's toolkit item. The dual-mode illumination is the reason it sells — the stealth setting is worth the price by itself. Deepguard certifies these for use in secured facilities where ambient light is controlled. The Generalist College includes them in all first-year student kits.

****Limitation:**** The personal mode produces light only the holder can see because it operates on a sympathetic frequency keyed to the holder's soul stone. Swapping the lantern to another person during operation requires a 1-minute recalibration.

****Soul Stone Cradle**** *(Synod of Endings — Osseous isotope, Solid phase)*

****EML:**** 2 | ****Slot:**** Neck | ****Value:**** Uncommon

****The Problem:**** Soul stones can be physically removed from a person's body, cutting off the automatic soul capture that occurs on death. This is the mechanism by which the gray market wipes soul stones. In combat, it's also a deliberate tactical target.

****What it does:**** A small carved bone housing worn on a neck cord that encloses the soul stone. The Cradle attaches the soul stone to the wearer's Pattern Integrity rather than to their physical body — it cannot be removed while the wearer is alive without first depleting their Metaphysical HP pool to the Corrupted step (Step 3) or lower. Ordinary physical theft or pickpocketing is blocked entirely.

****Use Case:**** Standard protective equipment for anyone operating in environments where soul stone theft is a risk — the gray market Volatile Fringe, deep bleed zones where the soul stone's anchoring might be disrupted, or intelligence operations where adversaries might attempt to convert your stone. Also purchased by people who simply cannot afford the resurrection consequences of losing their stone.

****Limitation:**** The Cradle does not protect against magical effects that target the stone directly (Deepguard's Soul-Drive Interface spell circumvents it). Against mundane theft, it is reliable.

****Exchange Compass**** *(Palimpsest — Echo isotope, Solid phase)*

****EML:**** 2 | ****Slot:**** Held or Waist | ****Value:**** Uncommon

****The Problem:**** You need to find the nearest Sovereign Exchange teleportation circle, and you're somewhere unfamiliar. Or you've taken a job that requires meeting an Exchange contact whose location you were given as a circle address, not a street address.

****What it does:**** A compass-style instrument whose needle points toward the nearest active Sovereign Exchange teleportation circle within 10 miles. A secondary function allows the holder to tune it to a specific registered circle address (written in the Exchange's planar notation system) — the needle then points to that specific circle regardless of distance, with the caveat that the direction arrow flickers if the circle is more than 50 miles away.

****Use Case:**** The practical tool for anyone working the Exchange's network. Couriers carry them. Field agents use them for extraction routing. Generalist College students assigned to Exchange-adjacent fieldwork are issued one for the duration. Also useful for anyone trying to avoid Exchange teleportation infrastructure — if you know where the circles are, you can route around them.

****Limitation:**** Only detects registered Exchange circles. Unauthorized circles, private circles, and Deepguard-sealed thresholds do not register. If the Exchange has been excluded from an area via Intercept Threshold, the compass shows no signal rather than pointing through the barrier.

****Ward Chalk**** *(Hidden Forge — Crystal isotope, Solid phase)*
****EML:**** 3 | ****Slot:**** Held (consumed, partial) | ****Value:**** Uncommon

****The Problem:**** You need temporary magical protection in an area where you cannot spend time inscribing a proper Deepguard ward. You have minutes, not hours.

****What it does:**** A stick of chalk infused with crystalline Hidden Forge resonance. Drawing a complete circle (any size, from a sleeping area to a doorway) as a standard action creates a Tier-1 magical ward along the chalk line. The ward triggers on the first creature that crosses it without the drawer's permission, applying a Reeling condition (Physical Track Step 2) and alerting the drawer regardless of distance as long as they are within 100 feet. The chalk line fades after 4 hours.

****Use Case:**** Camp security. The party draws a perimeter before sleeping. A single stick has 6 uses. Professional field use: draw a line across a door before going to sleep in a hostile inn. Budget Deepguard work for jobs that don't warrant a full installation. Also used by people who know someone is coming and want a warning system that doesn't look like a warning system.

****Limitation:**** The ward is single-trigger — it fires once and is gone. A careful infiltrator who detects the chalk line can step over it without triggering it (Discovery check TN 15). The Reeling condition lasts only 2 rounds — it is an alarm, not a barrier.

****Credo Coin**** *(Verdant Font + Sovereign Exchange — para-planar, Solid phase)*
****EML:**** 3 | ****Slot:**** Held or Digits | ****Value:**** Rare (Cursed Commerce)*

****The Problem:**** You need to make a binding promise to someone who has no reason to trust you, and you cannot access a Deepguard contract facility. Or you are in negotiations where the

other party's sincerity is the primary uncertainty.

****What it does:**** A Thalassus-touched coin carried in the cursed commerce economy. When two parties each hold one of a matched pair and verbally state the terms of an agreement, the coins bind the exchange. If either party violates the stated terms within 7 days, their coin runs cold and they immediately suffer the Distracted condition on their Social track — and the counterparty's coin runs warm, alerting them to the violation. The violation persists as a Social condition until the terms are fulfilled or both parties release the agreement.

****Use Case:**** The gray market alternative to an Iron Contract. Used when you need a binding agreement but cannot access (or don't want to involve) formal Deepguard contract infrastructure. Common in Cursed Commerce zones, in negotiations between factions that do not recognize each other's legal standing, and in the Volatile Fringe where standard contracts cannot be enforced by conventional means.

****Limitation:**** Credo Coins are Cursed Commerce instruments — carrying them is not illegal, but it marks you as someone operating outside Sanitized Commerce norms. Deepguard contract agents recognize them and will note your preference for non-institutional binding. Mortis Aevum does not recognize Credo Coin agreements as legally valid for resurrection priority disputes.

STAFF-GRADE (PERSISTENT, HIGHER EML)

****Field Chirurgeon's Satchel**** *(Verdant Font — Fauna isotope + Synod of Endings — Archival isotope, Liquid phase)*

****EML:**** 4 | ****Slot:**** Body (worn) | ****Value:**** Rare

****The Problem:**** You need to function as the party's primary healer but you have not invested significantly in the Medicine skill. Your healing spells restore HP but you keep losing people to condition track deterioration you cannot address in time.

****What it does:**** A leather satchel with Font/Synod emulsion woven into the lining. The satchel contains a regenerating supply of Chirurgeon's Compounds — 3 uses per day that restore themselves at dawn. More importantly: once per encounter, when you successfully restore HP to a target using any healing effect (spell, item, or talent), the satchel automatically moves that target one step up their Physical condition track without requiring a Medicine check. This is the passive application — the satchel recognizes a healing event and supplies the structural recovery.

****Use Case:**** The item that lets a non-Medicine character function as a combat medic in a pinch. The passive condition track improvement means you don't need Medicine ranks to perform the most critical battlefield function. Used by Stormpeak battlefield runners — soldiers whose job is keeping the line alive, not treating injuries. Also standard issue for Generalist College students on Mortis Aevum field placement.

****Limitation:**** The passive condition track improvement triggers once per encounter regardless of how many healing events occur. The three daily compounds are Chirurgeon's Flask equivalent — they do not scale with the user's Mastery. At higher tiers, this item's passive becomes less impactful as raw HP recovery outpaces condition track management.

****Deepguard Field Terminal**** *(Hidden Forge — Crystal isotope + Synod of Endings — Archival isotope, Solid phase)*

****EML:**** 4 | ****Slot:**** Body (worn) or Shoulders | ****Value:**** Rare (Licensed)*

****The Problem:**** You need to run a quick ward survey, verify contract status, or check soul stone registration records on a target — all of which normally require access to a Deepguard facility or a practitioner with Sigilry training.

****What it does:**** A compact crystalline panel worn on the forearm or as a shoulder device. Once per hour, the user can query the Deepguard public records database within range of a Deepguard crystal relay (present in all major settlements and most roads between them). Queries available: soul stone registration (is this stone registered, to whom, is it flagged), active contract status (is this person currently under any Deepguard-certified contract), and ward presence (are there active Deepguard-standard wards within Close range, yes/no only — no detail). Results arrive as text impressed in the crystal surface, visible only to the user.

****Use Case:**** The field intelligence tool for anyone working adjacent to Deepguard's systems. Exchange agents use them for client verification. Generalist College operatives use them for the ward presence check before entering secured locations. Sovereign Exchange repo-agents use them to verify that a contract is in active violation before executing a retrieval.

****Limitation:**** Requires access to a Deepguard relay network — works in settlements and on major routes, does not function in deep wilderness or Planar Bleed zones that disrupt crystal transmission. The device is Licensed: it logs every query to Deepguard's archive, including who asked and what they asked. There is no off-the-record query.

End of Novice Magic Items — Alpha Draft

Items use planar isotope combinations from the Warframe/Artifice design notes. EML values are within the Novice (1–4) band. Items marked Licensed require the relevant Background (Deepguard Rank, Exchange Rank, etc.) for unrestricted use. Items marked Cursed Commerce carry social/institutional flags that attentive NPCs may notice.